🌍 YMCA Newcomer Information Centre (NIC)

📍 What It Is

- A **free service** for newcomers in Ottawa
- Helps with **settlement, integration, and daily life in Canada**
- Support available in **multiple languages** (not just English/French)

🧰 Services Offered

🧾 Immigration & Settlement

- Information on:
  - Immigration & citizenship
  - Applications & processes
- Access to **settlement workers** for guidance

🏠 Life in Canada Support

- Help with:
  - Housing
  - Employment & training
  - Education
  - Healthcare
- Referrals to useful community services

💻 Resources & Tools

- Resource centre with:
  - Computers
  - Internet access
- Online materials & guides

🗣️ Language Support

- Referrals to:
  - Language assessments
  - Language classes

🎓 Workshops & Events

- Free webinars and sessions on topics like:
  - Citizenship
  - Family sponsorship
  - Driving test preparation
  - Financial basics

👉 Opportunity to:

- Learn practical skills
- Meet experts
- Connect with other newcomers

🚀 How to Get Started

1. Sign up as a client
2. Access resources & events
3. Meet with an Information & Referral Specialist

🎯 Key Benefits

- ✔ Completely **free**
- ✔ Personalized support
- ✔ Helps newcomers **adapt faster**
- ✔ Builds community connections

✅ Example

Scenario:
A new immigrant arrives in Ottawa

- Registers with NIC
- Attends a workshop on job search
- Meets a settlement worker

Result:
✔ Learns how to apply for jobs
✔ Gets referrals for language classes
✔ Feels more confident navigating life in Canada

💡 Key Idea

The NIC acts as a **"first stop"** to help newcomers:

- Understand systems in Canada
- Access the right services
- Successfully settle in Ottawa

🌍 OCISO – Ottawa Community Immigrant Services Organization

📍 Overview

- Serves **~10,000 immigrants & refugees each year**
- Operating since **1978**
- Services offered in **50+ languages**
- Supports people from **120+ countries**
- Multiple locations across Ottawa

🎯 Mission

- Help immigrants **make Canada their home**
- Provide:
  - Culturally appropriate programs
  - Language-accessible services
- Promote:
  - Inclusion
  - Community building
  - Safe and respectful environments

🌆 Vision

- An **inclusive Ottawa** where immigrants:
    - Share skills, culture, and values
    - Strengthen the community

🧰 Services & Support

- Settlement and integration support
- Community programs
- Language and cultural services
- Guidance for newcomers adjusting to life in Canada

🤝 Core Values

- Respect for all cultures
- Inclusion and diversity
- Social justice and equity
- Safe, discrimination-free environment
- Belief that everyone contributes to society

⚖️ Commitment to Equity

- Focus on:
    - Anti-racism
    - Anti-oppression
- Dedicated **Racial Equity Committee (REC)**
- Works to address discrimination and inequality

♿ Accessibility Commitment

- Follows accessibility standards (AODA)
- Ensures:
    - Equal service for people with disabilities
    - Accommodation for:
        - Assistive devices
        - Service animals
        - Support persons
- Staff trained to support accessibility needs

📍 Locations in Ottawa

- Central (Wellington St West)
- East End (St. Laurent Blvd)
- South End (Bank Street – LINC program)

👥 Who It Helps

- Immigrants
- Refugees
- Newcomers adjusting to life in Canada

✅ Example

Scenario:
A newcomer arrives in Ottawa and needs help settling

- Visits OCISO
- Gets support in their native language
- Receives guidance on housing, jobs, and community services

Result:
✔ Easier integration into Canadian society
✔ Access to resources and support
✔ Stronger sense of belonging

💡 Key Idea

OCISO helps newcomers:

- **Settle successfully**
- **Feel included**
- **Build a new life in Ottawa**

🌍 CCI Ottawa – Settlement Services

📍 Overview

- Provides **free, confidential, and culturally sensitive services**
- Helps immigrants and refugees **settle in Canada**
- Staff assess your needs and:
    - Help solve problems
    - Refer you to other services if needed

👥 Who Can Use These Services?

✔ Permanent residents
✔ International students
✔ Temporary foreign workers
✔ Refugees (government-assisted & privately sponsored)

❌ Not available for visitors (tourist visa)

🧰 Services Offered

📄 Documents & Applications

- Guidance for:
    - Driver's licence
    - Health card
    - Work permits
- ⚠️ They **do not fill out forms**, but guide you

🇨🇦 Citizenship Support

- Monthly workshops to prepare for:
    - Citizenship test

🏠 Housing Help

- Support with:
    - Finding housing
    - Understanding tenant rights
    - Dealing with landlords

🧠 Supportive Counselling

- Helps individuals & families:
  - Manage stress
  - Adjust to a new culture

👨‍👩‍👧 Youth Programs

- For ages **15–25**
- Workshops & activities to:
  - Stay engaged
  - Build skills

🏙️ Life in Ottawa Guidance

Learn practical things like:

- Using public transit (e.g., OC Transpo)
- Enrolling children in school
- Finding food & clothing
- Dressing for winter
- Filing taxes
- Free family activities

👨‍👩‍👧 Sponsorship Support

- Advice on:
  - Family sponsorship process

🎓 International Students Support

- Focus on **employment preparation**
- Helps with:
  - Resume building
  - Interview skills
  - Job search
  - Study permits & post-graduate work permits
- Goal: help transition to **permanent residence (Express Entry)**

🤝 Additional Help

- If CCI doesn't offer a service:
  - They **connect you with partner organizations**

✅ Example

Scenario:
An international student needs a job

- Visits CCI Ottawa
- Gets help building a resume
- Learns interview skills

Result:
✔ Better chances of finding a job
✔ Gains Canadian work experience
✔ Moves closer to permanent residency

💡 Key Idea

CCI Ottawa helps newcomers:

- **Understand life in Canada**
- **Access important services**
- **Build a stable future**

Links:
https://cciottawa.ca/programs-services/settlement-services/
https://ociso.org/our-values/
https://www.ymcaottawa-nic.ca/